

# Mohd Bilal

Korean Studies · Modern Korean History · Gender & Cultural History · Digital Humanities

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## Research profile

Korean Studies scholar specializing in modern and contemporary Korean history, colonial-era cultural history, gender history, and kisaeng studies. My research also engages with comparative Korean–Indian cultural history and Digital Humanities approaches to historical and cultural materials, examining gender, performance, cultural memory, representation, and cultural exchange across Korea and India.

## Education

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|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024–present | <b>M.A. in Korean Studies</b><br>The Academy of Korean Studies, Republic of Korea                             |
| Fall 2025    | <b>Exchange Student, International College</b><br>Seoul National University, Republic of Korea<br>GPA 4.3/4.3 |
| 2020–2023    | <b>B.A. in Korean Studies</b><br>Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi, India<br>GPA 3.43/4.00               |

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# Research & professional experience

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| 2025–present | <b>Graduate Teaching Assistant</b><br>Division of Global Korean Studies, The Academy of Korean Studies<br>Support teaching and academic activities across departmental courses and programs: course administration, preparation of academic materials, coordination of lectures and seminars, academic communication, proofreading, data collection, and departmental documents and reports.                                              |
| 2025         | <b>K-Campus Ambassador</b><br>JoongAng Ilbo, Seoul, Republic of Korea (March–August 2025)<br>Selected through JoongAng Ilbo's K-Culture platform; digital media and cultural communication activities, cross-cultural public engagement, and collaboration with student ambassadors from diverse national backgrounds.                                                                                                                    |
| 2024         | <b>University Research Assistant</b><br>The Academy of Korean Studies (September–December 2024)<br>Research Assistant on faculty-led project AKSR2024-C19: organization and execution of the 2024 AKS International Conference “A History of Luxury Goods Trade Network in Asia.”<br>Coordinated international scholars and logistics; proofread research papers and assisted in preparing conference proceedings, program, and schedule. |

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# Publications

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| Forthcoming  | <b>“Relic, Axis, and Adaptation: Selective Symbolic Preservation from the Indian Stūpa to the East Asian Pagoda.”</b><br><i>남아시아연구 (Journal of South Asian Studies)</i> 32, no. 2 (2026). Forthcoming. Accepted · in proofs.        |
| 2024         | <b>“Hybridizing Culture and Linguistics: A Case Study of K-Dramas’ Impact in India.”</b><br>With Santosh Kumar Ranjan. <i>The Myanmar Journal</i> 11, no. 1 (2024): 165–188.                                                        |
| Under review | <b>“The Role of Remakes and Adaptations in Activating Indian Agency.”</b><br><i>Asian Communication Research</i> , special issue “Circuits of K-content: Co-productions, Collaborations, and Connections.” Manuscript under review. |

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## Conference presentations

- 2026
- "A Comparative Study on Non-Verbal Communication in India and Korea."**  
International Young Researchers' Conference (IYRC 2026), New Delhi, India, January 2026.
- 2025
- "Religious Market Theory and the Logic of Commercialism: Mediatization and Branding in Contemporary Korean Buddhism."**  
International Conference on Korean Studies: "Culture, Identity, and Values in a Changing Korea," HSE University, St. Petersburg, Russia, December 2025.
- "Cultural Diversity or Token Identity? Interrogating Hallyu's Expansion into the Indian Market."**  
2025 KIAA-ICOFIS Joint Conference, Suncheon, Republic of Korea, October 2025.
- "Sacred Landscapes, Silenced Memories: The Disappearance of Buddhism from India and Its Survival in Korea."**  
"30 Years of Korean Studies at Sofia University: Korea—One Peninsula, Multiple Dimensions," Sofia University, Sofia, Bulgaria, October 2025.
- "The Role of Korean Webtoons in Informal Language Learning and Cultural Understanding in India."**  
Global K-Culture International Conference, Chungbuk National University, Cheongju, Republic of Korea, August 2025.
- "The Balloon War: Cross-Border Tensions on the Korean Peninsula."**  
SEAA-SNU Anthropology Conference: "Shaping Futures: East Asia as Practice," Seoul National University, Seoul, Republic of Korea, July 2025.
- "K-pop, Youth and Political Change: The New Face of Activism in South Korea."**  
NextGen Koreanist Workshop 2025, UP Korea Research Center and Yonsei University Mirae Campus, April 2025.
- "The Vegetarian by Han Kang: Environmental and Cultural Perspectives."**  
II International Young Researchers' Conference (IYRC 2025), Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi, India, January 2025.
- 2024
- "Exploring Transculturalism in Early Korean Classics: A Study of Samguk Yusa."**  
AKS International Conference 2024: "A History of Luxury Goods Trade Network in Asia: Past, Present, and Future," The Academy of Korean Studies, Seongnam, Republic of Korea, November 2024.

**“Beyond Stereotypes: Youth Realities in Korea and India.”**

6th Korea–India 2030 Forum, Institute of Indian Studies, Hankuk University of Foreign Studies, Seoul, Republic of Korea, September 2024.

**“A Comparative Analysis of Kisaeng and Devadasi in Post-Colonial Korea and India.”**

KIRL 2024 International Conference: “Inequality & Social Policy in South Korea,” Yonsei University, Seoul, Republic of Korea, August 2024.

**“Historical and Contemporary Buddhist Ties between India and Korea.”**

International M.A. & B.A. Students’ Conference “Young Korean Scholars about Korea,” HSE University, Moscow, Russia, June 2024.

**“Hallyu’s Influence on Indian Beauty Perceptions.”**

3rd AAPLAB International Conference: “Surface Tension: K-Art in the Hallyu Era,” Université de Montréal, Montreal, Canada, February 2024.

2023

**“Screen to Speech: Decoding K-Dramas’ Influence on Language Learning in India.”**

10th Korean Screen Culture Conference, Korean Studies Research Hub, Monash University, Melbourne, Australia, December 2023.

**“The Role of Buddhist Monks and Scholars in Promoting Public Diplomacy between India and Korea.”**

2023 International Conference for Public Diplomacy, Hankuk University of Foreign Studies, Seoul, Republic of Korea, November 2023.

**“Korean Pop Culture and Its Impact on Consumer Behaviour in India.”**

“50th Anniversary of India–Republic of Korea Diplomatic Relations: Emerging Korean Studies Scholars’ Conference,” Centre for East Asian Studies, Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi, India, September 2023.

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## Academic training

2026

**The 11th RIKS Academy for Young Scholars of Korean Studies**

Research Institute of Korean Studies (RIKS), Korea University (August 3–7, 2026)

2026

**20th Kyujanggak Korean Studies Summer School and Classical Chinese Workshop**

Seoul National University (June–July 2026)

2023

**17th Kyujanggak Korean Studies Summer Workshop**

Seoul National University (July 2023)

2022

**33rd AKS Summer Program for International Students**

The Academy of Korean Studies (August 2022)

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# Awards & fellowships

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|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024–present | <b>Academy of Korean Studies Graduate Scholarship for Master's Degree</b><br>Full tuition, monthly living stipend, research support, and Korean language training. |
| 2023–2024    | <b>Korea Foundation (KF) Scholarship for Graduate Studies</b><br>Awarded for research on Korea's kisaeng and India's devadasi.                                     |

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# Professional memberships

The Korean Association for Digital Humanities (KADH) · Royal Asiatic Society Korea Branch · Association for Korean Studies in Europe (AKSE)

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# Languages

Hindi (native) · English (academic fluency) · Korean (advanced) · Classical Chinese (intermediate)